

Tilly's Cornwall Dog Walk Guide

Five dog-friendly coastal walks — tested and approved by an opinionated golden retriever

THE FIVE WALKS

- WALK 1** **Porthkidney Beach, Lelant**
Dog-friendly all year round · Easy · 2–4 miles
- WALK 2** **Godrevy Headland & the Towans**
Best Sept–June · Moderate · 3 miles
- WALK 3** **Cape Cornwall & Priest's Cove**
Dog-friendly all year · Moderate · 3.5 miles
- WALK 4** **Marazion & Mount's Bay**
Dog-friendly all year · Easy · 3 miles
- WALK 5** **The Lizard: Kynance to Housel**
Dog-friendly all year · Moderate · 4 miles
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This guide covers five of our favourite dog walks on the Cornish coast — each one personal, tested in real weather, and approved by Tilly. No car parks we haven't stood in. No views we haven't sat and looked at for too long.

IMPORTANT BEFORE YOU GO

- Always bring a lead — livestock may be nearby on access paths
 - Check tide times before any beach walk — several routes narrow at high tide
 - Bring water and a travel bowl — coastal paths can be longer than they look
 - Keep dogs clear of estuary channels where tidal currents can be strong
 - Pick up after your dog — these are protected habitats and nesting bird areas
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TILLY'S NOTE

I have reviewed this guide. My ratings are objective. My opinions about the estuary at Walk 1 are not up for discussion.

The five walks — where to find them

All five walks are on the west Cornwall coast, within a comfortable drive of each other.



WALK LOCATIONS & POSTCODES

- 1

Porthkidney Beach, Lelant
TR26 3DY · Park near St Uny Church
- 2

Godrevy Headland
TR27 5ED · National Trust car park
- 3

Cape Cornwall
TR19 7EZ · Cape Cornwall / St Just TR19 7QQ
- 4

Marazion
TR17 0DX · Marazion Station car park
- 5

The Lizard: Kynance Cove
TR12 7PJ · National Trust car park

TILLY'S NOTE

I have strong opinions about the ordering of these walks. Walk 1 is objectively the best. This is not open for debate.

WALK 1 OF 5

Porthkidney Beach, Lelant

Dog-friendly all year round. The quiet alternative to St Ives that locals hope you won't find.

DISTANCE	2–4 miles depending on route and tide
DIFFICULTY	Easy — flat sand and dune paths, some soft sections
LEAD RULES	Lead required on footpath from St Uny Church. Off-lead on the beach.
DOG ACCESS	Year-round — no seasonal restrictions whatsoever
PARKING	Limited free parking near St Uny Church, Lelant TR26 3DY
FACILITIES	No facilities on the beach. Cove Café at the Hayle estuary end is dog-friendly.
TIDE NOTE	Check tide times — beach narrows at high tide. Best at mid to low tide.

ABOUT THIS WALK

Porthkidney Sands is one of those beaches that feels like a secret even though it isn't one. Two miles from St Ives but half the crowds, it stretches for nearly a mile at low tide between Lelant and Carbis Bay with sweeping views across St Ives Bay to Godrevy Lighthouse.

The most straightforward approach is from St Uny Church in Lelant — park on the lane near the church, keep your dog on the lead along the footpath that runs between the graveyard and the golf course, and within five minutes you are on the sand.

There are no facilities on the beach itself — no café, no toilets, no ice cream van — which is precisely why it never gets as busy as Carbis Bay or Porthminster. Bring everything you need. It is worth it every single time.

Longer option: walk in from Carbis Bay via Hawke's Point for a 4-mile return. Or take the St Ives branch railway to Lelant Station and walk the coast path back.

MY NOTES

TILLY'S RATING



TILLY'S NOTE

Five out of five. The sand goes on forever at low tide. I have investigated every inch of it. Twice.

WALK 2 OF 5

Godrevy Headland & the Towans

The lighthouse walk. Seals on the rocks, dunes behind, and Godrevy Café waiting at the end.

DISTANCE	3 miles circular (headland and dunes)
DIFFICULTY	Moderate — coastal grassland, some cliff edge paths
LEAD RULES	Dogs on leads on the headland.
DOG ACCESS	Headland: year-round. Godrevy Beach: restricted 1 July–31 August 10am–6pm.
PARKING	National Trust car park, Godrevy TR27 5ED · Free for NT members.
FACILITIES	Godrevy Café (dog-friendly) in the car park. Seasonal toilets at Godrevy Point.
TIDE NOTE	Low tide connects Gwithian and Godrevy beaches for a longer walk.

ABOUT THIS WALK

Godrevy is one of those places where you understand why people choose to live in Cornwall. The lighthouse sits on a low island just offshore — the one that inspired Virginia Woolf’s *To The Lighthouse* — and the headland around it has some of the best walking on the north coast.

From the car park, head out onto the headland via the coastal grassland. The path follows the clifftop past Hell’s Mouth lookout towards the seal viewing area — grey seals are regularly spotted on the rocks below, particularly in autumn and winter.

Best visited September to June when the beach dog restrictions are lifted and the car park is quieter. The Godrevy Café is one of the better beach cafés in Cornwall and welcomes dogs outside.

MY NOTES

TILLY’S RATING

TILLY’S NOTE*Four out of five. Minus one for the seal viewing area rule. I was merely interested. Seals are interesting.*

WALK 3 OF 5

Cape Cornwall & Priest's Cove

The wild end of England. Mining history, dramatic clifftops, and the Atlantic uninterrupted.

DISTANCE	3.5 miles circular from St Just
DIFFICULTY	Moderate — some steep sections, rugged coastal path
LEAD RULES	Dogs on leads throughout — mine shafts, steep drops, cattle on the headland
DOG ACCESS	Year-round on coast path. Priest's Cove beach: dogs banned Easter to 30 September.
PARKING	St Just TR19 7QQ (Market Street) or Cape Cornwall car park TR19 7EZ.
FACILITIES	St Just has cafés, pubs, shops and toilets.
NOTE	Botallack Crown Mines engine houses en route — worth a detour.

ABOUT THIS WALK

Cape Cornwall has the distinction of being the only cape in England and Wales — a headland where two seas meet. The walk from St Just follows the South West Coast Path through an extraordinary industrial landscape of derelict engine houses and mine stacks, past the iconic Crown Mines at Botallack perched impossibly above the sea.

Keep dogs on leads throughout — there are unfenced mine shafts across the landscape, steep drops to the sea, and cattle that graze the headland. St Just itself is one of the best towns in west Cornwall with good pubs and Moomaid ice cream.

Priest's Cove beneath the Cape is a small working beach with a raw, end-of-the-world quality. Avoid with dogs between Easter and end of September when the seasonal ban applies.

MY NOTES

TILLY'S RATING

TILLY'S NOTE *Four out of five. The mine shaft situation was pointed out to me repeatedly. I was being careful. Probably.*

WALK 4 OF 5

Marazion & Mount's Bay

St Michael's Mount on the horizon, wide firm sands, the most manageable walk on this list.

DISTANCE	3 miles one way (Marazion to Penzance, or return)
DIFFICULTY	Easy — wide, flat foot and cycle path along the bay
LEAD RULES	Dogs on leads on the path.
DOG ACCESS	Year-round on the coast path. Marazion Beach has some summer restrictions.
PARKING	Marazion Station car park, TR17 0DX. Pay and display.
FACILITIES	Marazion town has cafés, pubs, toilets. Godolphin Arms pub is dog-friendly.
NOTE	St Michael's Mount: dogs not permitted on the Mount itself.

ABOUT THIS WALK

The walk between Marazion and Penzance along the wide cycle and footpath that follows the shoreline of Mount's Bay is one of the most straightforward and scenically rewarding walks in west Cornwall. St Michael's Mount sits in the bay throughout the entire walk.

This is a good walk for dogs who are not yet experienced coast path walkers, or for days when the weather is dramatic but you want to be outside anyway. The Godolphin Arms in Marazion is one of the best dog-friendly pubs in the area.

At low tide it is worth walking across the causeway to look at St Michael's Mount from the other side — dogs are not permitted on the Mount, but the view back across the bay from the causeway is worth the trip.

MY NOTES

TILLY'S RATING

TILLY'S NOTE	<i>Three out of five. Good smells. Acceptable views. Deeply unfair situation regarding the Mount. I am lodging a formal complaint.</i>
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WALK 5 OF 5

The Lizard: Kynance to Housel Bay

The southernmost point of mainland Britain. The water genuinely looks tropical in good light.

DISTANCE	4 miles circular from Kynance Cove car park
DIFFICULTY	Moderate — coastal path with steep descents, clifftop walking
LEAD RULES	Dogs on leads on NT-managed clifftop sections.
DOG ACCESS	Year-round on coast path. Check NT seasonal restrictions for Kynance beach.
PARKING	Kynance Cove National Trust car park TR12 7PJ. Free for NT members.
FACILITIES	NT café at Kynance Cove (dog-friendly outside). Lizard village has pub and shops.
NOTE	The Lizard peninsula is genuinely less visited than west Cornwall.

ABOUT THIS WALK

Kynance Cove is one of the most photographed spots in Cornwall, and the view on a clear day — turquoise water, cream sand, dramatic serpentine rock stacks — does actually look like the photographs suggest. The coast path south from Kynance to Lizard Point passes through National Nature Reserve heathland blazing with gorse and heather.

Lizard Point is the most southerly point of mainland Britain — worth reaching just to stand there and look out. Continue northeast from the Point to Housel Bay for a quieter cove before looping back through Lizard village.

Best in autumn or spring when the heathland is at its most dramatic and the paths are almost entirely yours.

MY NOTES

TILLY'S RATING

TILLY'S NOTE *Five out of five. The heathland smells extraordinary. I require a return visit at once. This is non-negotiable.*

The Wild Coast Mama Full Walk Guide

Twenty lesser-known beaches and coastal walks — the ones the guidebooks don't mention.

This free guide covers five walks we love. The full guide goes further — twenty routes across Cornwall including some of the least-visited beaches on the entire coast path.

Each walk in the full guide includes everything in this one — distance, difficulty, lead rules, parking, facilities, tide notes — plus seasonal advice, the best picnic spots, dog-friendly cafés and pubs on the route, and Tilly's rating for each one.

WHAT'S IN THE FULL GUIDE

- 20 walks across Cornwall — West Penwith, the Lizard, North Coast, and south coast coves
 - Hidden beaches with free parking and no seasonal dog bans
 - Best low-tide walks — routes that only open up when the sand is out
 - Van-friendly walks — park overnight and walk straight from your van door
 - Tilly's personal rating out of five for every single walk
 - Seasonal guide — which walks are best in which months
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Available at wildcoastmama.co.uk

*The Wild Coast Mama Cornwall Walk Guide — the full twenty walks,
from the ones everyone knows to the ones almost nobody does.*

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TILLY'S NOTE

I have personally walked all twenty routes. My standards are high. The guide meets them. Mostly.